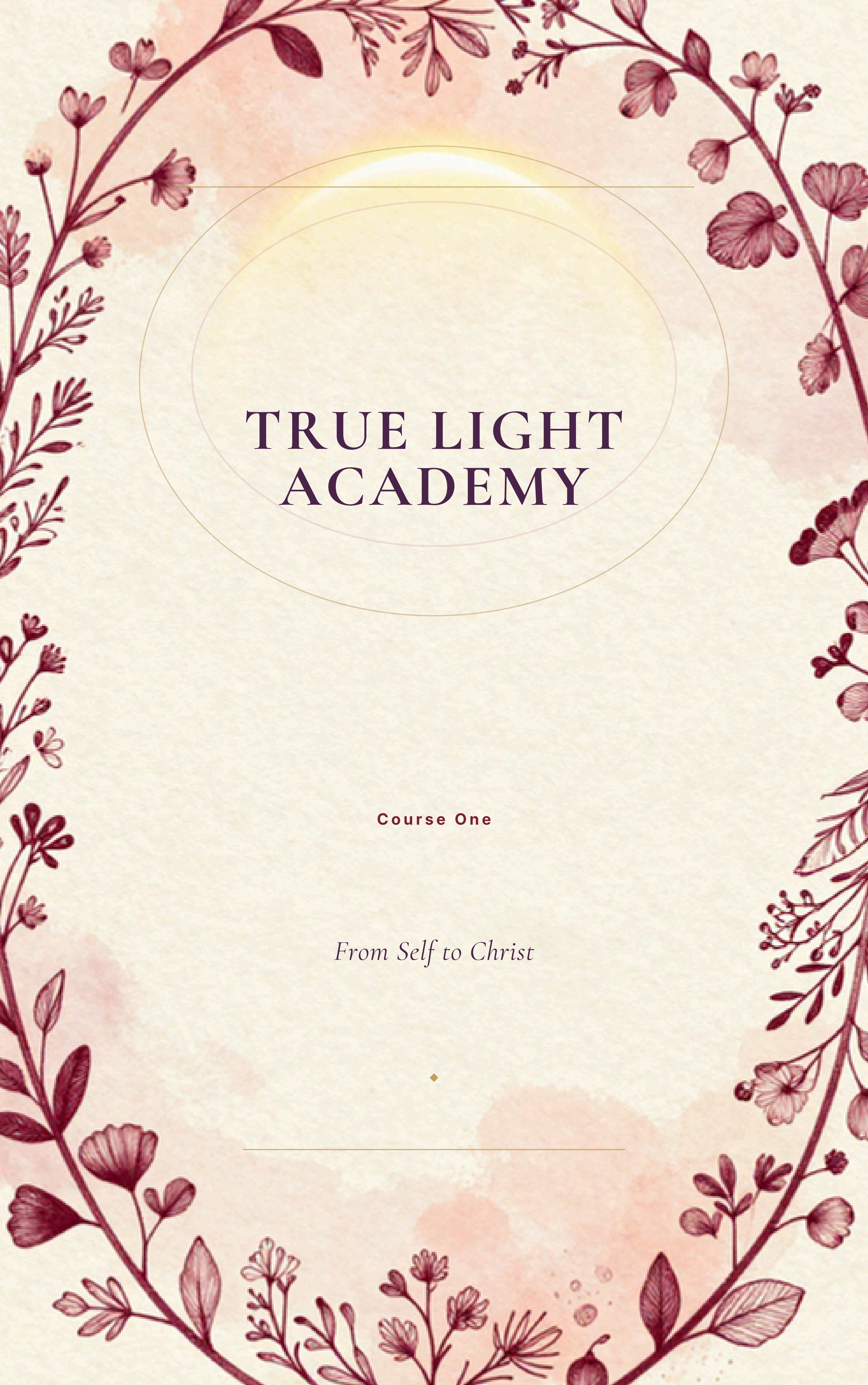


written by
Berhanu Tadesse

FROM SELF TO CHRIST



The background features a soft, watercolor-style sun in shades of yellow and orange at the top center. It is framed by delicate, dark red floral and leafy branches that curve around the edges of the page. Two thin, concentric circles in a light gold color are centered on the page, with the main title text placed within the inner circle.

TRUE LIGHT ACADEMY

Course One

From Self to Christ



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➤ Scripture Quotations ◀

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TRUE LIGHT ACADEMY

Welcome to True Light Academy

Dear Friend,

Welcome to True Light Academy.

It is a joy and a privilege to welcome you to this journey of discipleship in Jesus Christ. This course was born from years of searching, questioning, praying, studying God's Word, and discovering a life-changing truth: true transformation is not found by trying harder, but by knowing Christ more deeply.

Course One is not simply a collection of Bible lessons. It is an invitation to walk with Jesus.

Together we will discover who we are in Christ, learn how God transforms the heart and renews the mind, understand His Kingdom, follow Him daily, abide in His presence, bear the fruit of the Spirit, shine His light, love others, make disciples, live by faith, persevere through every season, and ultimately live for the glory of God.

My prayer is that these pages will do more than increase your knowledge.
I pray they will draw you into a deeper relationship with Jesus Christ and
encourage you to become a faithful disciple who reflects His life to the
world.

Welcome to the journey. May Christ, the True Light, lead every step you take.



Berhanu Aberra Tadesse

Founder, True Light Academy

Course Journey

Course One: From Self to Christ

Part One: Discovering New Life in Christ

Identity → Heart → Spirit → Mind

Part Two: Walking with Christ

Kingdom → Following → Abiding → Fruit

Part Three: Living the Life of a Disciple

Light → Love → Mission → Faith → Perseverance → God's Glory



Course Introduction



Many people know about God, yet few truly understand who they are in Christ. Lasting transformation begins when truth renews the mind and reveals our identity through Jesus Christ.

This course is designed to help you discover biblical truth, understand God's kingdom principles, and grow in a life that reflects Christ. Each lesson builds upon the previous one, leading you from knowledge to understanding, from understanding to faith, and from faith to practical living.

Take your time with each lesson. Allow God's Word to speak to your heart, and invite the Holy Spirit to guide your understanding. As you continue this journey, my prayer is that Christ becomes increasingly visible in your life and that His light shines through you to the world.



How to Use This Course



This course is designed to guide you step by step into a deeper understanding of God's truth and a transformed life in Christ.
To receive the greatest benefit:

- 1 Study one lesson at a time without rushing.
- 2 Read every Scripture carefully before continuing.
- 3 Take time to reflect on the questions at the end of each lesson.
- 4 Pray and ask the Holy Spirit to reveal Christ through His Word.
- 5 Apply what you learn in your daily life before moving to the next lesson.
- 6 Review previous lessons whenever necessary.
- 7 Review previous lessons whenever necessary.

The goal of this course is not merely to gain knowledge but to experience genuine transformation through the truth of God's Word.



May the Lord lead you as you walk in His light.



Part One – Discovering New Life in Christ

Lesson One

The Greatest Discovery: Who Am I?

Theme Verse

*"So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female
He created them."*

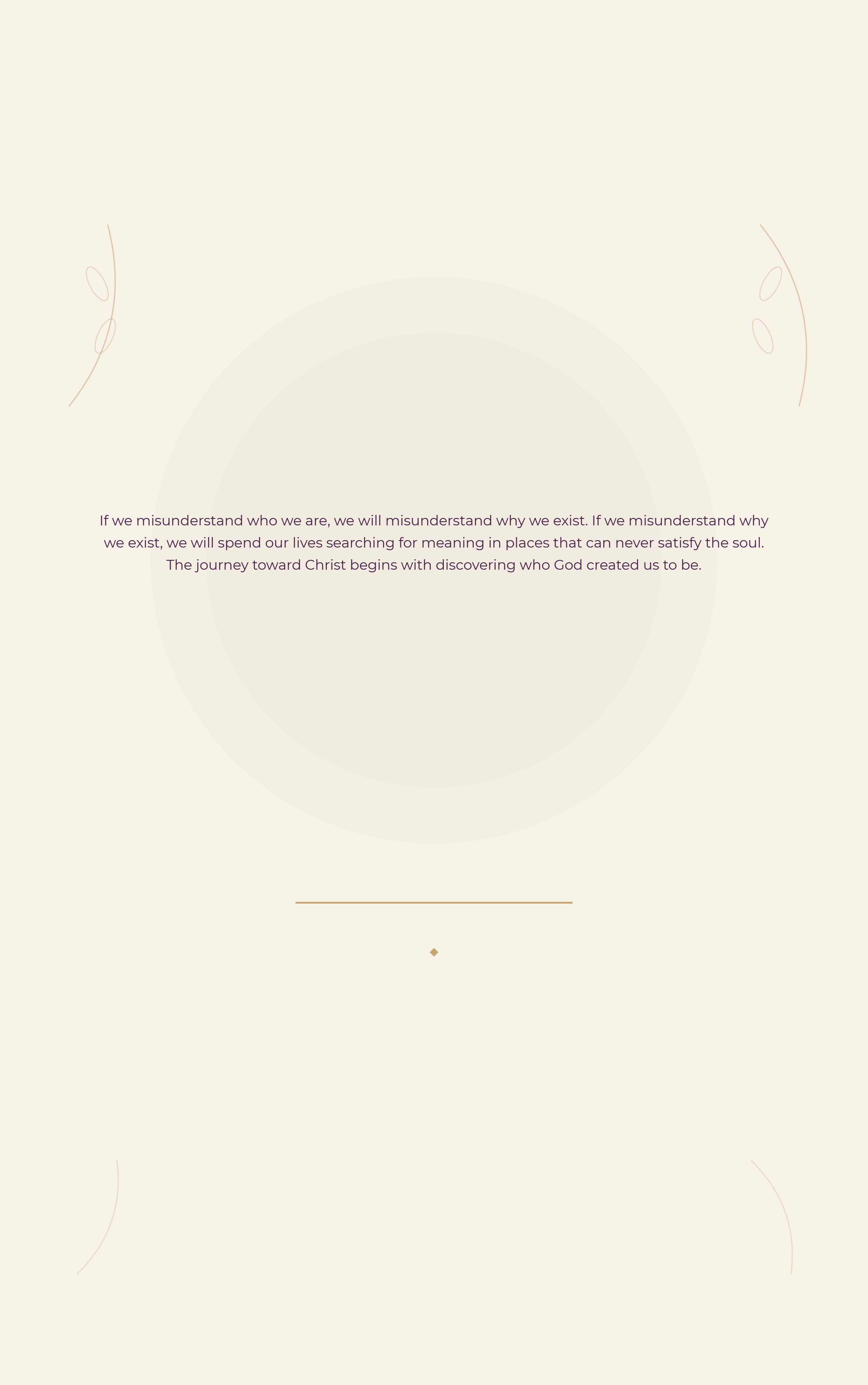
(Genesis 1:27)

Introduction

Before we can understand God, we often ask another question: Who am I?

Every person wrestles with this question, whether they realize it or not. Some find their identity in success. Others find it in wealth, education, relationships, nationality, career, or religion. But none of these can fully answer the deepest question of the human heart.

The Bible teaches that our identity is not something we create—it is something we receive from our Creator.

The background features a large, light beige circle centered on the page. In the top-left and top-right corners, there are thin, curved lines with small ovals attached, resembling stylized leaves or branches. At the bottom center, there is a horizontal line with a small diamond shape below it.

If we misunderstand who we are, we will misunderstand why we exist. If we misunderstand why we exist, we will spend our lives searching for meaning in places that can never satisfy the soul. The journey toward Christ begins with discovering who God created us to be.

I. Created in the Image of God

The Bible begins with an astonishing truth. Human beings are different from everything else God created. Mountains display His power. The stars display His greatness. The oceans display His majesty. But humanity alone was created in His image.

Being created in God's image means that we were made to know Him, love Him, reflect His character, and enjoy fellowship with Him. Our value does not come from what we own or accomplish. Our value comes from the One who created us. Every human life has dignity because every person bears the image of God.

2. The Tragedy of Losing Our Identity

Although humanity was created for fellowship with God, sin entered the world. Sin did more than separate us from God. It distorted how we see ourselves. Instead of living as God's children, people began searching for identity in temporary things. Some pursue acceptance. Others pursue power. Others pursue pleasure. Still others pursue recognition. Yet even after achieving these things, many still feel empty. **Why?** Because the human heart was created for God. Nothing less can satisfy it.

3. Jesus Restores Our True Identity

The good news of the Gospel is not merely that our sins can be forgiven. It is that our identity can be restored. Through Jesus Christ we are invited into a new relationship with God.

Scripture declares: "Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; the old has passed away; behold, the new has come." (2 Corinthians 5:17)

Our past no longer defines us. Our failures no longer define us. Our achievements no longer define us. Christ defines us. In Him we become children of God, loved by the Father and called to reflect His character in the world.

Reflection

Take a few quiet moments and consider these questions:

Where have I looked for my identity?

What has shaped the way I see myself?

Do I truly believe my worth comes from being created and loved by God?

What would change in my life if I fully embraced my identity in Christ?

Write your thoughts in a journal before moving to the next section.

Life Application

This week, whenever you find yourself measuring your value by success, failure, or the opinions of others, pause and remind yourself: **"My identity is found in Jesus Christ, not in my circumstances."** Allow this truth to shape your thoughts, decisions, and relationships.



Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for creating me in Your image and loving me with an everlasting love. Forgive me for searching for my identity in things that cannot satisfy. Help me to see myself as You see me. Through Jesus Christ, restore my heart, renew my mind, and teach me to live as Your child. May my life reflect Your goodness and bring glory to Your name.

*In Jesus' name,
Amen.*

Key Takeaway

True transformation begins when we stop defining ourselves by the world and begin seeing ourselves through the eyes of our Creator.

The True Light Principle:

You will never fully understand your purpose until you discover your identity in Christ.

Understanding the Human Heart

Theme Verse

"The good person out of the good treasure of his heart produces good, and the evil person out of his evil treasure produces evil, for out of the abundance of the heart his mouth speaks."

(Luke 6:45)

Introduction

Why do people say things they later regret? Why do we sometimes know what is right but still choose what is wrong? Why do fear, pride, anger, jealousy, and selfishness seem to rise from within us?

The Bible points us to the heart. In Scripture, the heart is far more than our emotions. It is the center of our inner life—the place where our thoughts, desires, choices, and affections come together. Everything we do flows from it.

If our hearts remain unchanged, lasting transformation will never take place. We may change our behavior for a season, but sooner or later, the true condition of the heart will reveal itself. Jesus did not come merely to improve our actions. He came to transform our hearts.

I. The Heart Is the Source of Our Life

The Bible teaches:

"Keep your heart with all vigilance, for from it flow the springs of life." (Proverbs 4:23)

Every decision begins in the heart before it appears in our actions. Our words reveal our hearts. Our attitudes reveal our hearts. Our priorities reveal our hearts. Our choices reveal our hearts. This is why God looks beyond appearances. While people often judge by what they can see, God examines what no one else can see—the heart.

2. A Broken Heart Cannot Heal Itself

Many people try to solve inner problems by changing outward circumstances. They think: "If I had more money..." "If I had a better job..." "If people treated me differently..." "If I lived somewhere else..." Yet even when circumstances improve, the emptiness often remains.

Why?

Because the deepest problem is not around us—it is within us. Only God can heal what sin has broken. Only God can give us a new heart.



3. God's Promise Is a New Heart

One of God's most beautiful promises is found in the book of Ezekiel:

"I will give you a new heart, and a new spirit I will put within you." (Ezekiel 36:26)

God does not merely repair the old heart. He gives us a new heart through Jesus Christ. As we trust Him, the Holy Spirit begins changing our desires. We start loving what God loves. We begin turning away from what separates us from Him. This transformation is often gradual, but it is real. Day by day, Christ shapes us into His likeness.

Reflection

Spend a few moments quietly considering these questions:

What attitudes or desires most often influence my decisions?

Are there areas where I have focused only on changing my behavior instead of allowing God to change my heart?

What would it look like to surrender my heart completely to Christ?

How is God inviting me to trust Him with the deepest parts of my life?

Write your thoughts in your journal and pray honestly before God.

Life Application

Throughout this week, before making an important decision, pause and ask yourself:

"Is this decision coming from a heart that is seeking God, or from fear, pride, selfishness, or personal desire?"

Invite the Holy Spirit to guide your heart before you act.



Prayer

Heavenly Father,

You know my heart better than I know it myself. Thank You for loving me despite my weaknesses and failures. Search my heart, reveal anything that keeps me from You, and create within me a heart that delights in Your will. Fill me with Your Holy Spirit so that my thoughts, words, and actions may reflect the character of Jesus Christ. Transform me from the inside out, for Your glory.

In Jesus' name,

Amen.

Key Takeaway

True change begins in the heart. When God transforms the heart, the life follows.

The True Light Principle

God is not merely changing what you do; He is transforming who you are by giving you a new heart.

The Battle Between the Flesh and the Spirit

Theme Verse

"For the desires of the flesh are against the Spirit, and the desires of the Spirit are against the flesh... to keep you from doing the things you want to do."

(Galatians 5:17)

Introduction

Have you ever found yourself asking, "Why do I still struggle even though I believe in Jesus?"

Many followers of Christ sincerely desire to obey God, yet they often experience an inner conflict. They want to love, but anger rises. They want to forgive, but resentment remains. They want to trust God, yet fear seems stronger than faith.

This struggle does not necessarily mean your faith is weak. It means there is a battle taking place within you. The Bible describes this as the conflict between the flesh and the Spirit. Understanding this battle is essential because victory begins when we recognize both the source of the conflict and the One who gives us the power to overcome it.



I. Understanding the Flesh

In the New Testament, the word "flesh" does not simply refer to our physical body. It refers to our fallen human nature—the tendency to live independently of God and according to our own sinful desires.

The flesh says:

"I know what is best." "I want my own way." "I will satisfy myself first." The flesh seeks control, recognition, and self-centered living.

Even after coming to Christ, believers may still experience these old patterns. The presence of the struggle does not mean Christ has abandoned us; it reminds us that spiritual growth is an ongoing process.

◆

2. The Work of the Holy Spirit

When we place our faith in Jesus Christ, God gives us the gift of the Holy Spirit. The Holy Spirit is not merely an influence or a feeling. He is God’s presence living within every believer.

His work is to:

- ◆ Lead us into truth.
- ◆ Convict us of sin.
- ◆ Strengthen us to obey God.
- ◆ Produce Christlike character.
- ◆ Help us grow into the likeness of Jesus.

The Christian life is not lived by human determination alone. It is lived by daily dependence upon the Holy Spirit.



3. Walking by the Spirit

Paul gives us a wonderful promise:

"Walk by the Spirit, and you will not gratify the desires of the flesh." (Galatians 5:16)

Notice that Paul does not simply tell us to resist the flesh. He tells us to walk with the Spirit. Victory is not found merely by trying harder. It is found by drawing closer to Christ. As we spend time in God's Word, pray, worship, obey His voice, and depend upon the Holy Spirit, our desires begin to change.

Little by little, the fruit of the Spirit becomes evident in our lives: Love. Joy. Peace. Patience. Kindness. Goodness. Faithfulness. Gentleness. Self-control. These qualities are not produced by human effort alone; they are the work of God's Spirit within us.

4. Victory Is a Daily Choice

The Christian life is not a single moment of victory but a daily walk of surrender. Each day we choose whom we will follow. Will we allow fear or faith to guide us? Will we respond with pride or humility? Will we seek our own desires or God's will? Jesus calls us to deny ourselves, take up our cross daily, and follow Him. Every act of surrender becomes another step toward spiritual maturity. The more we walk with Christ, the more His life is reflected in ours.

Reflection

Spend a few quiet moments before God and consider these questions:

- In what areas of my life do I experience the greatest spiritual struggle?
- Am I relying on my own strength or on the Holy Spirit?
- What habits help me walk closely with Christ?
- What is one area I need to surrender to God today?

Write your answers honestly, remembering that God desires truth in the inward being.

Life Application

This week, whenever you face temptation, frustration, or discouragement, pause before reacting.

Pray this simple prayer:

"Holy Spirit, lead me to respond as Jesus would."

Allow that prayer to become the beginning of a new habit of depending upon God throughout your day.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for not leaving me to fight this battle alone. Thank You for giving me Your Holy Spirit to guide, strengthen, and transform me. Teach me to depend on You each day rather than on my own strength. Help me to deny myself, follow Jesus faithfully, and bear the fruit of the Spirit in every area of my life. May my thoughts, words, and actions increasingly reflect the character of Christ.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

Key Takeaway

The Christian life is not about trying harder; it is about walking closer with Christ through the power of the Holy Spirit.

The True Light Principle

Victory over the flesh is not achieved by human effort but by daily surrender to the Holy Spirit, who transforms us into the likeness of Christ.

The Renewing of the Mind

Theme Verse

"Do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewal of your mind..."

(Romans 12:2)

Introduction

Transformation does not begin by changing our circumstances. It begins by changing the way we think. Before coming to Christ, our minds were shaped by the values of the world, our personal experiences, and our own understanding. We learned to think independently of God, often measuring success, happiness, and purpose by human standards.

When we receive Christ, God begins a lifelong work of renewing our minds. He teaches us to see life through His truth rather than through our emotions, culture, fears, or past experiences. A renewed mind leads to a transformed life.

I. The Mind Directs the Life

Every action begins with a thought. Our beliefs influence our choices. Our choices shape our habits. Our habits eventually shape our character. If our thinking remains unchanged, our lives will continue following the same patterns. This is why Scripture places such importance on the mind. God desires not only our obedience but also our understanding. As our minds are renewed by His truth, our lives begin to reflect His wisdom.

2. Replacing Lies with Truth

Many people unknowingly build their lives upon false beliefs. *"I am not valuable."* *"I will never change."* *"God cannot forgive me."* *"My worth depends on what others think."* These thoughts may feel true, but feelings are not always faithful guides. God's Word becomes the standard by which every thought must be tested.

Jesus declared, "You will know the truth, and the truth will set you free." (John 8:32)

Freedom begins when God's truth replaces the lies we have believed. The renewed mind is not merely filled with information. It is filled with truth that changes how we live.

3. The Mind of Christ

Paul writes, "But we have the mind of Christ." (1 Corinthians 2:16)

To have the mind of Christ is not simply to know what Jesus knew. It is to begin seeing life as He sees it. It means learning to value what He values. To love what He loves. To hate what destroys people. To trust the Father's will above our own understanding.

As we spend time in Scripture and walk with the Holy Spirit, our thinking becomes more like Christ's thinking. Transformation is not instant, but it is certain for those who continue abiding in Him.

4. Renewing the Mind Every Day

Renewing the mind is not a one-time event. It is a daily choice. Each day we decide what will shape our thinking. **Will it be fear... or faith?**

The world's opinions... or God's Word?

Temporary pleasures... or eternal truth?

Every day we have the opportunity to surrender our thoughts to Christ. The more we fill our minds with God's truth, the more our lives reflect His character.

Reflection

Take time to consider these questions before God:

What beliefs have most influenced the way I think?
Are there lies about myself or about God that I still believe?
How can I spend more time allowing God's Word to shape my thinking?
What thought does God want me to surrender to Him today?

Write your reflections honestly and invite the Holy Spirit to renew your mind.

Life Application

Throughout this week, whenever a negative or fearful thought enters your mind, stop and ask yourself:

"Does this thought agree with God's Word?"

If it does not, replace it with a biblical truth. Allow Scripture—not your emotions—to become the foundation of your thinking.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for Your Word, which is truth. Forgive me for the times I have allowed fear, doubt, and worldly thinking to shape my life. Renew my mind through Your Holy Spirit and help me see myself, others, and the world through the eyes of Christ. Fill my heart with Your truth and lead me to think in ways that honor You. May every thought be brought into obedience to Jesus Christ.

In His precious name,

Amen.

Key Takeaway

A transformed life begins with a renewed mind, and a renewed mind is shaped by the truth of God's Word.

The True Light Principle

God transforms our lives by renewing our minds until we begin to think, choose, and live like Jesus Christ.

Part Two – Walking with Christ

Lesson Five

Living Under the Kingdom of God

Theme Verse

"But seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added to you."

(Matthew 6:33)

Introduction

When Jesus began His earthly ministry, His first message was not about religion. It was about the Kingdom of God. Throughout the Gospels, Jesus continually spoke about God's Kingdom because He came not only to forgive our sins but to restore us to God's rule.

Many people think becoming a Christian simply means preparing for heaven. The Bible teaches something much greater. Through Jesus Christ, we are invited to live under God's Kingdom today.

A kingdom is wherever the king rules. When Christ becomes Lord of our lives, His Kingdom begins to shape our thoughts, choices, relationships, and purpose. Following Jesus is not merely accepting a new belief. It is entering a new Kingdom.



I. What Is the Kingdom of God?

The Kingdom of God is God's sovereign rule over all creation. It is not limited by geography. It is not confined to a church building. It is not identified with one nation or culture. Wherever God's will is joyfully obeyed, His Kingdom is present. Jesus came to announce that God's Kingdom had drawn near. He invites every person to leave the kingdom of self and enter the Kingdom of God through faith in Him.

2. Two Kingdoms

Every person lives under one of two kingdoms. The kingdom of self says: *"My will be done." "My desires come first." "My life belongs to me."*

The Kingdom of God says: *"Your will be done." "My life belongs to Christ." "I live for His glory."* The greatest battle of the Christian life is not between people. It is between these two kingdoms. Every day we choose which kingdom will govern our hearts.

3. Citizens of Heaven

The Apostle Paul reminds us:

"But our citizenship is in heaven, and from it we await a Savior, the Lord Jesus Christ."

(Philippians 3:20)

Although we live in this world, we no longer belong to its values. ***Our identity... Our loyalty... Our hope... Our purpose...*** are now found in Christ. As citizens of God's Kingdom, we are called to represent our King wherever we live. Our homes become places where Christ reigns. Our workplaces become opportunities to reflect His character. Our churches become communities that display His love. Every area of life becomes an opportunity to honor our King.

4. Seeking the Kingdom First

Jesus made an extraordinary promise:

"Seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness, and all these things will be added to you."

(Matthew 6:33)

Notice He did not say, "**Seek success first.**" "**Seek comfort first.**" "**Seek wealth first.**" *He said, **Seek the Kingdom first.***

When God's Kingdom becomes our highest priority, every other area of life finds its proper place. The Christian life is not about adding Jesus to our plans. It is about surrendering our plans to Jesus.

Reflection

Take time to prayerfully consider these questions:

Who truly rules my life?
In what areas do I still struggle to surrender to Christ's authority?
What does it mean for me to seek God's Kingdom first each day?
How can I better represent Christ's Kingdom in my home, workplace, church, and community?

Write your reflections and ask God to reveal any area where He is inviting you to trust Him more fully.

Life Application

This week, begin each morning with one simple prayer:

"Lord Jesus, You are my King. May Your will be done in my life today."

Before making important decisions, ask:

"Does this choice reflect the values of God's Kingdom or the desires of my own kingdom?"

Allow every decision to become an act of worship.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for inviting me into Your Kingdom through Jesus Christ. Forgive me for the times I have lived according to my own will instead of Yours. Teach me to seek Your Kingdom above everything else. Rule over my thoughts, my heart, my words, and my actions. Help me to live each day as a faithful citizen of heaven, reflecting the love, truth, and righteousness of my King.

In the name of Jesus Christ,

Amen.

Key Takeaway

The Christian life begins when Jesus becomes more than our Savior—He becomes our King.

The True Light Principle

Transformation reaches its fullness when we leave the kingdom of self and joyfully live under the Kingdom of God.

Lesson Six

Following Jesus Daily

Theme Verse

"If anyone would come after Me, let him deny himself and take up his cross daily and follow Me."

(Luke 9:23)

Introduction

Many people admire Jesus. Many believe in Jesus. Many speak about Jesus. But Jesus never invited people merely to admire Him. He invited them to follow Him. Following Jesus is more than agreeing with His teachings. It is choosing Him every day. It is allowing His life to shape our lives. His words to shape our thinking. His love to shape our relationships. His purpose to become our purpose. The Christian life is not simply believing certain truths. It is walking with a living Savior. Every day.

I. Jesus Calls Us to Follow Him

Throughout the Gospels, Jesus repeatedly gave the same invitation. ***"Follow Me."*** He spoke those words to fishermen. To tax collectors. To ordinary men and women. He did not first ask about their education. Their wealth. Their abilities. He simply invited them into a relationship with Himself. The call has not changed. Today Jesus still says, ***"Follow Me."*** **Discipleship always begins with His invitation.**

2. Following Jesus Requires Surrender

Jesus never promised that following Him would always be easy. Instead He said,

"If anyone would come after Me, let him deny himself..."

To deny ourselves does not mean rejecting our value. It means surrendering our right to rule our own lives.

It means saying, "Lord, Your will is greater than mine. Your wisdom is greater than mine. Your Kingdom is greater than mine."

Every day we are faced with a choice. Will I follow myself? Or will I follow Christ?

True discipleship begins with daily surrender.

3. Taking Up Our Cross

The cross was more than a symbol. It represented complete obedience to the Father. When Jesus tells us to take up our cross daily, He invites us into the same life of obedience. **Sometimes obedience requires sacrifice. Sometimes it requires patience. Sometimes forgiveness. Sometimes courage.** Sometimes letting go of what we want so we can embrace what God desires. The cross reminds us that following Jesus costs something. ***But it also reminds us that nothing we surrender to Christ is ever lost in His Kingdom.***

4. Walking with Jesus Every Day

Following Jesus is not an event. It is a relationship. Relationships grow through time spent together.

We walk with Christ by:

- ◆ Reading His Word.
- ◆ Speaking with Him in prayer.
- ◆ Listening to the Holy Spirit.
- ◆ Obeying His voice.
- ◆ Serving others in love.
- ◆ Trusting Him in every circumstance.

The more closely we walk with Him, the more we become like Him.

Discipleship is not measured by how much we know. It is measured by how closely we follow Jesus.

Reflection

Take time to quietly reflect before God.

Ask yourself:

- ◆ Am I merely believing in Jesus, or am I truly following Him?
- ◆ What area of my life is hardest to surrender?
- ◆ What does taking up my cross look like today?
- ◆ How can I intentionally walk more closely with Jesus this week?

Write your thoughts honestly before the Lord.

Life Application

This week, begin each morning with one simple question:

"Lord Jesus, what would You have me do today?"

Then intentionally obey the first opportunity God gives you to demonstrate His love, humility, truth, or forgiveness.
Following Jesus is learned one step of obedience at a time.



Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for calling me to follow Your Son.

Teach me to surrender my own desires and to trust Your perfect will.

Give me the courage to take up my cross each day and the joy of walking closely with Jesus.

May my life become a reflection of His humility, compassion, obedience, and love.

Help me not merely to know about Christ, but to faithfully follow Him wherever He leads.

In His precious name,

Amen.



Key Takeaway

Discipleship is not simply believing in Jesus; it is faithfully following Him every day.

The True Light Principle

The closer we follow Jesus, the more His life is revealed through ours.



Lesson Seven

Abiding in Christ

Theme Verse

"Abide in Me, and I in you. As the branch cannot bear fruit by itself, unless it abides in the vine, neither can you, unless you abide in Me."

(John 15:4)

Introduction

One of the greatest misunderstandings about the Christian life is the belief that spiritual growth depends primarily on our own effort. Many people begin their journey with Christ full of enthusiasm.

They promise to pray more, serve more, read more, and do better. While these are valuable practices, they are not the source of spiritual life.

Jesus revealed a much deeper truth. He said, "I am the vine; you are the branches."

(John 15:5)

A branch does not struggle to produce fruit. It bears fruit because it remains connected to the vine. In the same way, the Christian life is not sustained by human strength but by a living relationship with Jesus Christ. Transformation is the fruit of abiding.

I. What Does It Mean to Abide?

To abide means to remain, dwell, continue, or stay closely connected. Abiding in Christ is not visiting Him occasionally. It is making Him the center of our daily lives. It means trusting Him in every circumstance. Listening to His voice through His Word. Speaking with Him in prayer. Walking in obedience. Depending upon His grace every day. Abiding is not an activity we perform once. ***It is the atmosphere in which a disciple lives.***

2. Jesus Is the Source of Life

Jesus declared, "Apart from Me you can do nothing."
(John 15:5)

These words remind us that spiritual fruit does not originate within ourselves.

Love... Joy... Peace... Patience... Kindness... Faithfulness...

These are not qualities we manufacture. They grow naturally as Christ lives within us.

The closer we remain to Jesus, the more His character is reflected through our lives.

3. Abiding Produces Fruit

God is not merely interested in outward activity. He desires inward transformation that produces lasting fruit. Jesus spoke of fruit that remains. This fruit includes:

- ♦ A growing love for God.
- ♦ A deeper love for people.
- ♦ Increasing obedience.
- ♦ Christlike character.
- ♦ Faithful service.
- ♦ Lives that point others to Jesus.

Fruit is evidence that Christ is working within us. It is not the cause of our relationship with Him but the result of it.

4. Remaining Close Every Day

Abiding is not reserved for Sundays or special moments of worship. It is a daily walk.

We abide in Christ by:

- Remaining in His Word.
- Praying continually.
- Listening to the Holy Spirit.
- Obeying what He teaches.
- Trusting Him during trials.
- Giving thanks in every circumstance.

As we remain close to Christ, we discover that the Christian life is less about striving and more about depending.

The greatest strength of a disciple is not self-confidence.

It is Christ-confidence.

Reflection

Spend a few quiet moments before the Lord.

Ask yourself:

- ◆ Am I trying to live the Christian life in my own strength?
- ◆ What helps me remain close to Jesus?
- ◆ What distractions are pulling me away from Him?
- ◆ How can I cultivate a deeper relationship with Christ each day?

Write your reflections honestly before God.

Life Application

This week, intentionally set aside at least fifteen uninterrupted minutes each day simply to be with Jesus. Read a portion of Scripture. Pray. Sit quietly in His presence. Listen. Allow this time to become

the most important appointment of your day.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for giving me life through Your Son, Jesus Christ. Teach me to remain in Him each day. Forgive me for the times I have depended upon my own strength instead of Yours. Draw me closer to Jesus through Your Word, through prayer, and through the guidance of the Holy Spirit. May my life bear fruit that brings glory to You and points others to Christ. Help me to remain faithful until the day I see Him face to face. In the name of Jesus,

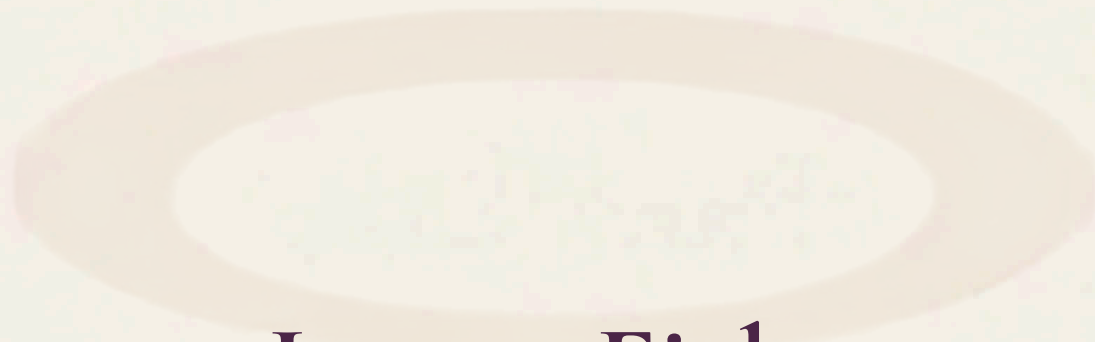
Amen.

Key Takeaway

The Christian life is not sustained by striving but by abiding in Jesus Christ.

The True Light Principle

The closer we remain in Christ, the more His life flows through us, producing fruit that glorifies God.



Lesson Eight

Bearing the Fruit of the Spirit

Theme Verse

"But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, patience, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, self-control; against such things there is no law."

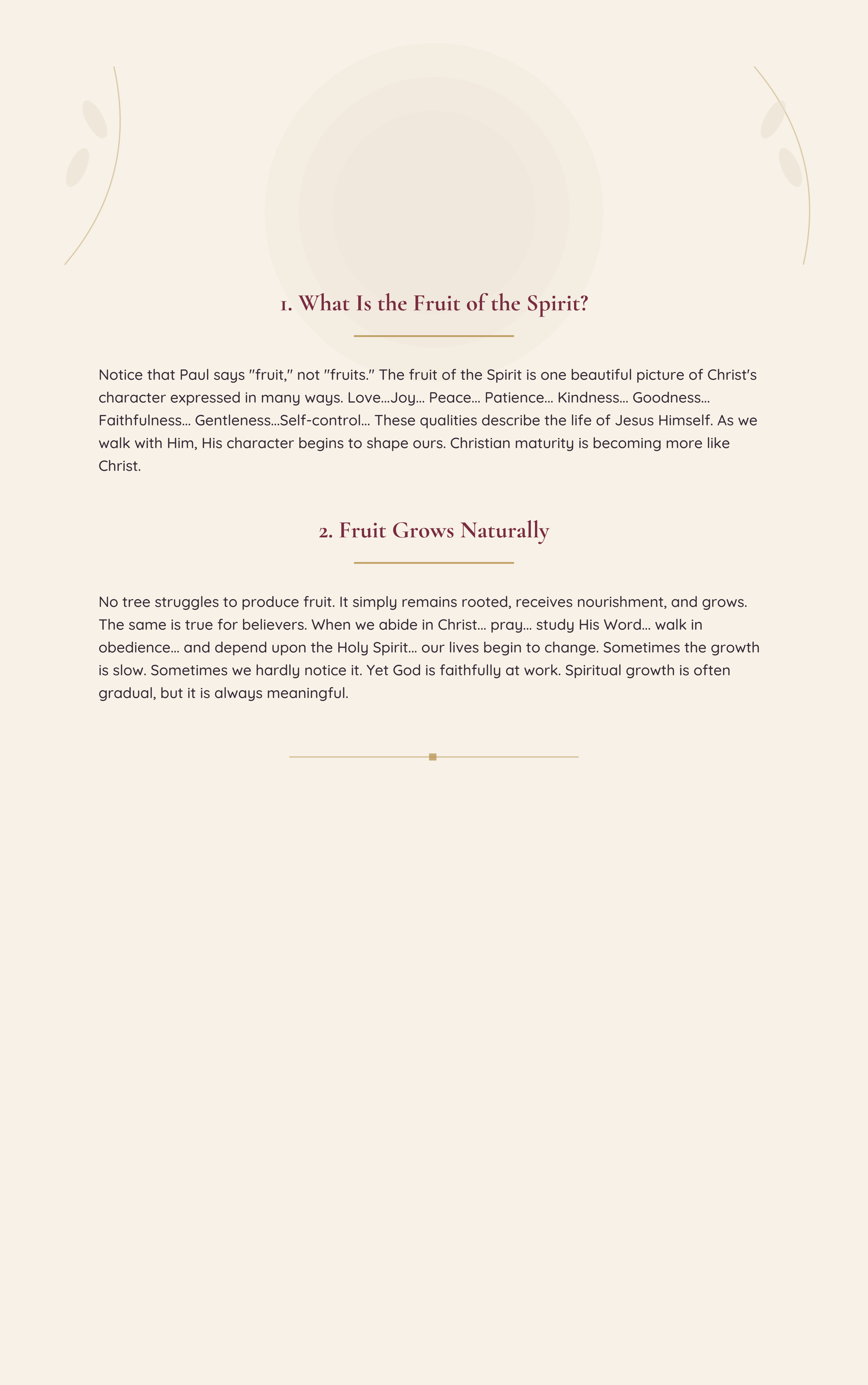
(Galatians 5:22-23)

Introduction

How do we know that Christ is transforming our lives? Is it by how much we know? By how many Bible verses we can quote? By how often we attend church? **These are valuable, but Jesus taught that a transformed life is recognized by its fruit.**

Just as a healthy tree naturally bears healthy fruit, a life that remains in Christ will gradually reflect His character. The fruit of the Spirit is not something we manufacture through human effort. It is the evidence that the Holy Spirit is living and working within us. God is not only interested in changing what we do. He desires to change who we are.





1. What Is the Fruit of the Spirit?

Notice that Paul says "fruit," not "fruits." The fruit of the Spirit is one beautiful picture of Christ's character expressed in many ways. Love...Joy... Peace... Patience... Kindness... Goodness... Faithfulness... Gentleness...Self-control... These qualities describe the life of Jesus Himself. As we walk with Him, His character begins to shape ours. Christian maturity is becoming more like Christ.

2. Fruit Grows Naturally

No tree struggles to produce fruit. It simply remains rooted, receives nourishment, and grows. The same is true for believers. When we abide in Christ... pray... study His Word... walk in obedience... and depend upon the Holy Spirit... our lives begin to change. Sometimes the growth is slow. Sometimes we hardly notice it. Yet God is faithfully at work. Spiritual growth is often gradual, but it is always meaningful.



3. The World Sees Christ Through Our Fruit

Jesus said,

"By this My Father is glorified, that you bear much fruit and so prove to be My disciples." (John 15:8)

People may never read the Bible. But they will read our lives. They will notice how we respond when we are hurt. How we treat difficult people. How we speak. How we forgive. How we serve. The fruit of the Spirit becomes a living testimony of Christ's presence within us. Our lives become the message before our words are ever heard.

4. Growing Through Every Season

Fruit does not appear overnight. Neither does spiritual maturity. God often uses every season of life to help us grow. Times of joy teach us gratitude. Trials teach us perseverance. Waiting teaches us trust. Success teaches us humility. Failure teaches us dependence. In every season, the Holy Spirit is shaping us into the image of Jesus Christ. Nothing in the hands of God is wasted. Every experience can become part of our spiritual growth.

Reflection

Spend time with the Lord and ask yourself:

Which fruit of the Spirit is becoming evident in my life?

Which area needs the greatest growth?

Am I focusing more on outward performance or inward transformation?

How is God using my current circumstances to make me more like Christ?

Write your reflections honestly and invite the Holy Spirit to continue His work within you.

Life Application

Choose one fruit of the Spirit that you especially desire to grow this week. Pray about it each morning. Throughout the day, intentionally look for opportunities to practice that quality. At the end of each day, thank God for every opportunity He gave you to become more like Jesus.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for giving me Your Holy Spirit. Thank You for patiently transforming my life day by day. Produce within me the character of Jesus Christ. Help me to love as He loved. To rejoice in every circumstance. To live in Your peace. To be patient, kind, faithful, gentle, and self-controlled. May my life become a testimony that points others to You. Continue Your work in me until Christ is fully reflected through my life.

In Jesus' name,
Amen.

Key Takeaway

The fruit of the Spirit is the visible evidence of Christ living within us.

The True Light Principle

The closer we walk with Christ, the more His character becomes visible through our lives.

Lesson Nine

Being the Light of the World

Theme Verse

"You are the light of the world. A city set on a hill cannot be hidden."

(Matthew 5:14)

Introduction

Every follower of Jesus carries a divine purpose. God did not save us merely to prepare us for heaven. He saved us so that His light might shine through us here on earth. Jesus never said, "Try to become the light." He said, "You are the light of the world." Because Christ, the True Light, lives within us, His light is now reflected through our lives. The world is filled with darkness. Darkness of fear. Darkness of confusion. Darkness of loneliness. Darkness of sin. Yet wherever Christ is present, His light begins to overcome the darkness. As disciples, we are called to live in such a way that people see Jesus through us.



I. Christ Is the True Light

Jesus declared,

"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows Me will not walk in darkness, but will have the light of life."

(John 8:12)

Jesus alone is the source of spiritual light. He reveals the Father. He exposes sin. He guides us into truth. He gives life where there was death. Without Christ, humanity walks in darkness. With Christ, everything changes. He is not merely a teacher who points toward the light. He is the Light.



2. We Reflect His Light

The moon has no light of its own. It shines because it reflects the light of the sun. The same is true for every believer. We are not the source of spiritual light. Christ is. Our calling is simply to reflect His life to the world around us.

When people experience our love... our kindness... our humility... our forgiveness... they should see something beyond us. They should catch a glimpse of Jesus Christ. The brighter our relationship with Him becomes, the brighter His light shines through us.

3. Light Changes Everything

Light does not argue with darkness. It simply shines. The moment light enters a dark room, darkness begins to disappear. Jesus calls us to live this way. Instead of responding to hatred with hatred, we answer with love. Instead of spreading fear, we bring hope. Instead of increasing division, we become peacemakers. Instead of hiding our faith, we courageously live for Christ. The greatest sermon many people will ever hear is the testimony of a life transformed by Jesus.



4. Living for God's Glory

Jesus concluded His teaching by saying,

"Let your light shine before others, so that they may see your good works and give glory to your Father who is in heaven." (Matthew 5:16)

Notice something important. The goal is not that people admire us. The goal is that they glorify God. Every act of kindness... every word of truth... every expression of grace... every sacrifice made in love... becomes another opportunity for people to see the goodness of our heavenly Father. The light is never about us. It always points to Christ.

Reflection

Spend time quietly before the Lord and ask yourself:

Does my life reflect the character of Jesus?

In what places has God called me to be His light?

Is there anything that is dimming His light in my life?

How can I point someone to Christ through my words or actions this week?

Write your reflections and ask the Holy Spirit to make you a faithful witness.

Life Application

Choose one person this week who needs encouragement. Show them the love of Christ through a practical act of kindness. It may be a conversation... a prayer... a phone call... a visit... an act of generosity... or simply listening with compassion. Ask yourself afterward, *"Did this help someone see Jesus more clearly?"*

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for sending Your Son, the True Light of the world. Thank You for bringing me out of darkness into Your marvelous light. Help me to reflect the character of Jesus wherever I go. May my words encourage, my actions reveal Your love, and my life point others to Christ. Keep me humble so that all glory belongs to You alone. Use me as an instrument of Your light in a world that desperately needs hope.

In the name of Jesus,

Amen.

Key Takeaway

The purpose of our lives is not to draw attention to ourselves but to reflect the light of Jesus Christ so that others may glorify God.

The True Light Principle

The brighter Christ shines within us, the brighter His light shines through us to the world.

Lesson Ten

Living a Life of Love

Theme Verse

"A new commandment I give to you, that you love one another: just as I have loved you, you also are to love one another."

(John 13:34)

Introduction

The greatest evidence of a transformed life is not found in impressive words or remarkable abilities. It is found in love. From the beginning of His ministry to the cross, Jesus demonstrated the love of the Father. He welcomed the outcast. He forgave sinners. He healed the broken. He served the humble. He laid down His life for the world. When we follow Jesus, His love becomes the pattern for our lives. Christian love is not merely a feeling. It is a decision to seek the good of others, even when it requires sacrifice. Love is the language of the Kingdom of God.

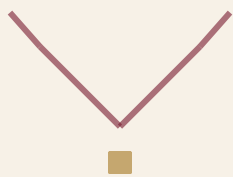




I. God Is the Source of Love

The Bible declares, "God is love." (1 John 4:8)

Love does not begin with us. It begins with God. Before we ever loved Him, He loved us. He pursued us when we were lost. He forgave us when we were guilty. He welcomed us through Jesus Christ. Every act of genuine Christian love flows from the love we have first received from our heavenly Father. The more we understand His love for us, the more naturally we love others.





2. Loving as Jesus Loved

Jesus raised the standard of love. He did not simply say, "Love others as they love you." He said, "Love one another as I have loved you." His love was humble. His love was patient. His love was forgiving. His love was truthful. His love was sacrificial. He loved even those who rejected Him.



To follow Jesus is to allow His love to shape the way we speak, serve, forgive, and respond to others. This kind of love cannot be produced by human effort alone. It is the work of the Holy Spirit within us.

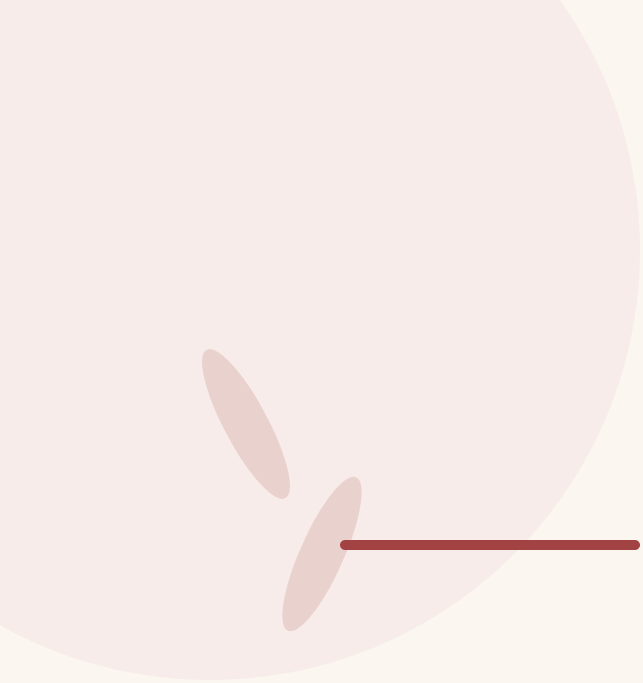


3. Love in Action



Love is more than words. It is demonstrated through everyday actions. We show love by: Forgiving those who hurt us. Encouraging those who are discouraged. Serving without seeking recognition. Listening with compassion. Giving generously. Praying for others. Speaking the truth with grace. Love often appears in small acts of faithfulness that reveal the heart of Christ. Every act of love becomes an opportunity for someone to experience God's kindness.





4. Love Reflects Christ to the World

Jesus said,
"By this everyone will know that you are My disciples, if
you love one another."
(John 13:35)

The world is searching for authentic love. When believers love one another with humility, patience, and grace, they reveal something extraordinary. They reveal Jesus. Our love becomes a testimony more powerful than arguments. It opens hearts. It heals wounds. It builds unity. It points people to the Savior. Love is not simply one Christian virtue among many. It is the atmosphere in which all the other virtues flourish.





Reflection

Spend time before the Lord and ask yourself:

- Have I truly experienced God's love in a personal way?
- Is there someone I need to forgive?
- How do my words and actions reflect Christ's love?
- Who is God calling me to love more intentionally this week?

Write your reflections honestly and ask the Holy Spirit to deepen your love for God and for others.

Life Application

Choose one intentional act of love each day this week. It may be: Offering forgiveness, Encouraging someone with sincere words, Helping a person in need, Praying for someone who has wronged you, Serving without expecting recognition. At the end of each day, thank God for every opportunity to demonstrate the love of Christ.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,
Thank You for loving me before I ever loved You. Thank You for revealing Your perfect love through Jesus Christ. Fill my heart with Your love so completely that it overflows into every relationship. Teach me to forgive as You have forgiven me. Help me to serve with humility, speak with kindness, and love without expecting anything in return. May my life become a reflection of Your love so that others may come to know Jesus through me.
In His holy name,
Amen.

Key Takeaway

The clearest evidence of a transformed life is a heart that loves as Christ loves.

The True Light Principle

The light of Christ shines most brightly through a life filled with His love.

Making Disciples

Theme Verse

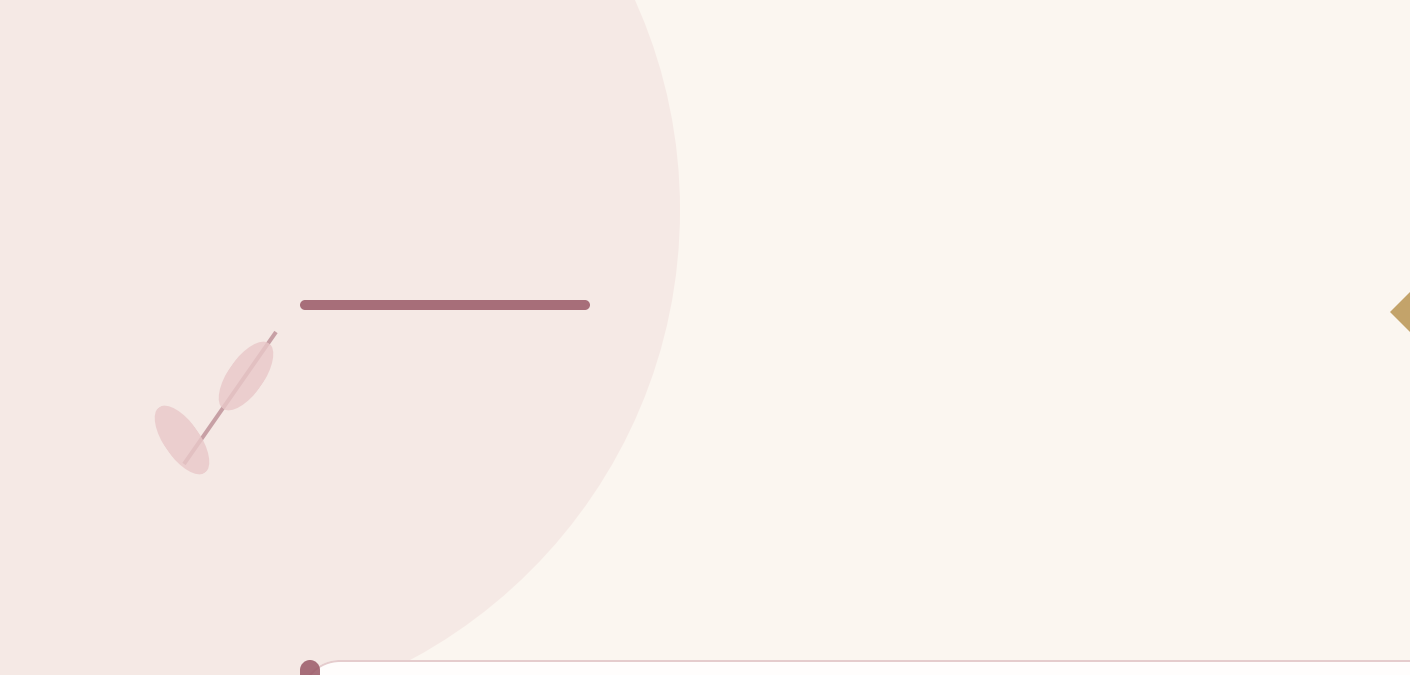
"Go therefore and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, teaching them to observe all that I have commanded you. And behold, I am with you always, to the end of the age."

(Matthew 28:19–20)

Introduction

The Christian life does not end with personal transformation. It begins there. Jesus never called His followers simply to believe in Him. He called them to follow Him... to become like Him... and then to help others do the same.

Every disciple is called to make disciples. This is not about building our own reputation or gathering followers for ourselves. It is about pointing people to Jesus Christ, helping them grow in faith, and encouraging them to walk faithfully with Him. Discipleship is the natural overflow of a life transformed by the Gospel.

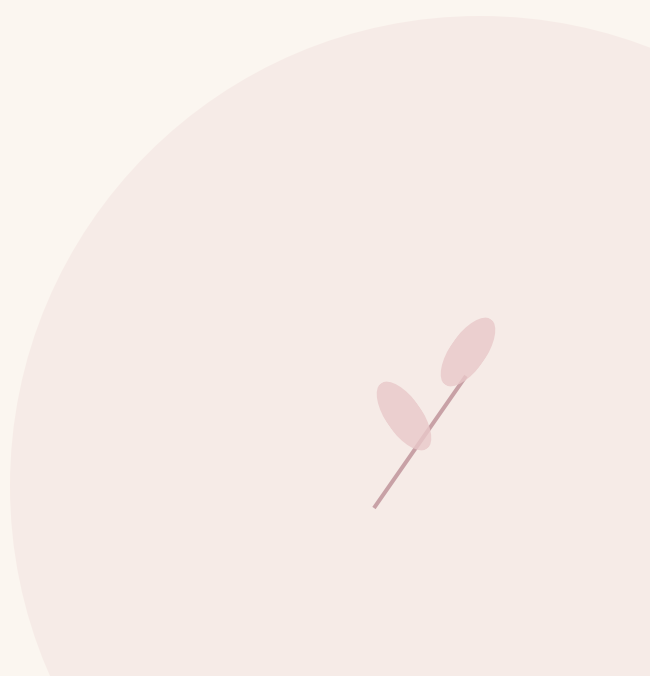


1. What Is a Disciple?

A disciple is more than someone who possesses knowledge about Jesus. A disciple is a learner, a follower, and an obedient servant of Christ. A disciple listens to Jesus. Trusts Jesus. Obeys Jesus. Lives for Jesus. And becomes increasingly like Jesus. Discipleship is not measured by how much information we have. It is measured by how faithfully we live what Christ has taught us.

2. Every Disciple Is Sent

Before Jesus returned to the Father, He entrusted His mission to His followers. This was not a suggestion. It was a commission. The Great Commission reminds us that every believer has a purpose. Some serve in their homes. Some in their workplaces. Some in churches. Some across nations. Wherever God places us, we are called to represent Christ and help others know Him. The mission field begins wherever God has planted us.

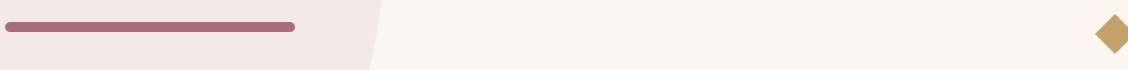


3. Making Disciples Through Everyday Life

Making disciples is not limited to classrooms or pulpits. It happens in everyday relationships. We make disciples by:

- Living lives that reflect Christ.
- Sharing the Gospel with humility and courage.
- Teaching God's Word faithfully.
- Praying with and for others.
- Encouraging new believers.
- Walking alongside those who are growing in their faith.

Discipleship is not about creating dependence upon ourselves. It is about leading people into a deeper relationship with Jesus Christ.



4. Multiplying the Mission

One disciple reaches another. That disciple reaches another. Generation after generation, the Gospel continues to spread. This was God's design from the beginning. The Church grows not merely by gathering crowds, but by multiplying faithful disciples. Our greatest legacy is not what we accumulate. It is the people we have encouraged, equipped, and pointed toward Christ. When we invest our lives in others, the impact of the Gospel extends far beyond our own lifetime.

Reflection

Spend time before the Lord and consider these questions:

- Who has helped me grow as a disciple of Jesus?
- Whom is God calling me to encourage or mentor?
- Am I intentionally sharing my faith with others?
- How can my daily life point someone toward Christ?

Write your reflections and ask God to make you a faithful disciple-maker.

Life Application

This week, pray for one person by name. Ask God to open a door for you to encourage them spiritually. It may be through: Sharing your testimony. Inviting them to study the Bible. Praying together. Offering a word of encouragement. Simply demonstrating the love of Christ through your actions. Take one faithful step and trust God with the results.

Prayer

Prayer

Heavenly Father,
Thank You for calling me to be Your disciple. Thank You for patiently teaching me and transforming my life. Help me to faithfully carry the mission You have entrusted to me. Give me courage to share the Gospel with love and humility.

Teach me to invest in others, encourage those who are growing in faith, and always point people to Jesus Christ. May my life multiply Your Kingdom and bring glory to Your name.

*In the name of Jesus,
Amen.*

Key Takeaway

Every disciple of Jesus is called to help others know, follow, and grow in Christ.

The True Light Principle

A transformed life does not stop with personal growth—it multiplies by leading others to Jesus Christ.

Living by Faith

Theme Verse

*"For we walk by faith, not by sight."
(2 Corinthians 5:7)*

Introduction

The Christian life begins by faith. We are saved by faith in Jesus Christ. But faith is not only the doorway into the Christian life—it is also the pathway on which we continue to walk. Faith is trusting God even when we do not understand everything He is doing. It is believing His promises when circumstances seem uncertain. It is obeying His Word even when obedience requires courage.

Throughout Scripture, the people God used most powerfully were not those who had every answer. They were those who trusted Him. Faith is confidence in the character of God. Because He is faithful, we can trust Him completely.

I. What Is Faith?

The writer of Hebrews tells us:

"Now faith is the assurance of things hoped for, the conviction of things not seen."

(Hebrews 11:1)

Faith is not wishful thinking. It is not pretending that problems do not exist. Biblical faith rests upon God's promises and His unchanging nature. Faith looks beyond present circumstances and places confidence in the One who holds the future. When we know God's character, trusting Him becomes a natural response.

2. Faith Grows Through God's Word

Paul writes,

"Faith comes from hearing, and hearing through the word of Christ."

(Romans 10:17)

Our faith grows as we spend time in God's Word. The Scriptures remind us of His faithfulness. They strengthen our hope. They correct our thinking. They encourage us during trials. The more we fill our hearts with God's truth, the more confidently we can trust Him. Faith is nourished by knowing the God who speaks.

3. Faith Is Expressed Through Obedience

Faith in action

Faith is more than believing God's promises. It is acting upon them. Abraham left his homeland because he trusted God's call. Noah built the ark before he saw the flood. Peter stepped out of the boat because Jesus invited him.

In each case, faith was demonstrated through obedience. Our faith becomes visible when we choose to obey God, even when we cannot see the entire journey ahead. **Obedience is faith in action.**



4. Faith Sustains Us Through Every Season



The Christian life includes seasons of joy and seasons of hardship. There are times when God's direction seems clear. There are times when we must wait patiently. Faith reminds us that God's presence does not depend on our feelings.

He is with us in every season. When we experience success, faith gives glory to God. When we experience trials, faith holds firmly to His promises. The God who began His work in us will faithfully complete it.



Reflection

Spend time quietly before the Lord and consider these questions:

- Where is God asking me to trust Him more deeply?
- Am I allowing fear or uncertainty to guide my decisions?
- What promise from Scripture encourages my faith today?
- How can I demonstrate my trust in God through obedience this week?

Write your reflections and ask God to strengthen your faith.

Life Application

Choose one area of your life where you have been hesitant to trust God. Bring it before Him in prayer. Read a passage of Scripture that speaks to His faithfulness. Then take one practical step of obedience, trusting Him with the outcome. Remember, faith grows as it is exercised.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for being completely faithful. When my understanding is limited, help me to trust Your wisdom. When I feel weak, remind me of Your strength. Teach me to walk by faith and not by sight. Help me to obey You with confidence, knowing that You are always working for Your glory and my good. Strengthen my heart to follow You wherever You lead.

In the name of Jesus Christ,
Amen.

Key Takeaway

Faith is trusting God's character, relying on His promises, and obeying His Word even when we cannot see the entire path ahead.

The True Light Principle

A disciple walks confidently, not because the path is always visible, but because the One who leads is always faithful.

Persevering Until the End

Theme Verse

"Let us not grow weary of doing good, for in due season we will reap, if we do not give up."

(Galatians 6:9)

Introduction

Every journey has moments of excitement. Every journey also has moments of weariness. The Christian life is no different. There are days when our faith feels strong. There are seasons when God's presence seems especially near. But there are also times of waiting... times of suffering... times of unanswered questions... and times when we feel like giving up. Jesus never hid these realities from His disciples. Instead, He encouraged them to remain faithful. The Christian life is not measured by how quickly we begin. It is measured by how faithfully we continue. God calls us not only to believe, but to endure with hope until the end.

I. Trials Are Part of the Christian Journey

Jesus said,

"In the world you will have tribulation. But take heart; I have overcome the world."

(John 16:33)

Following Christ does not remove every difficulty. Sometimes our faith is tested. Sometimes our patience is stretched. Sometimes our obedience is costly. Yet none of these experiences surprise God. He walks with us through every trial. The presence of hardship does not mean God has abandoned us. Often it is during hardship that His faithfulness becomes most visible.

2. God Uses Trials to Mature Us

James writes,

"Count it all joy... when you meet trials of various kinds, for you know that the testing of your faith produces steadfastness."

(James 1:2–3)

God does not waste our struggles. He uses them to shape our character. Trials teach us to trust Him more deeply. Waiting develops patience. Challenges strengthen our faith. Suffering often produces compassion for others. As difficult as they may be, these seasons become opportunities for spiritual growth. God is more concerned with our character than our comfort.

3. Hope Gives Us Strength to Continue

Our perseverance is rooted in hope. We do not endure because we are strong. We endure because Christ is faithful. The Apostle Paul reminds us,

"He who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ."

(Philippians 1:6)

The God who called us is the God who keeps us. He never abandons His children. Even when we feel weak, His grace is sufficient. Hope reminds us that our present struggles are temporary, but God's promises are eternal.

4. Finishing Faithfully

Near the end of his life, Paul wrote,

"I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith."

(2 Timothy 4:7)

What a beautiful testimony. Paul did not claim a perfect life. He testified to a faithful finish. God does not ask us to be flawless. He calls us to remain faithful. One day, every believer longs to hear these words from Jesus:

"Well done, good and faithful servant."

(Matthew 25:23)

Our goal is not simply to begin the race. Our goal is to finish it with our eyes fixed on Christ.

Reflection

Spend time with the Lord and reflect on these questions:

- 1 What challenge am I facing today?
- 2 How has God been faithful to me in the past?
- 3 What promise from Scripture gives me hope?
- 4 How can I encourage someone else who is growing weary?

Write your reflections and thank God for His sustaining grace.

Life Application

Think of one area where you have been tempted to give up. Instead of focusing on the difficulty, focus on God's faithfulness. Choose one promise from Scripture and meditate on it each day this week. If you know someone who is discouraged, encourage them with prayer, a message, or a visit. Sometimes God strengthens others through our faithfulness.

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for walking with me through every season of life. When I grow weary, renew my strength. When I face trials, increase my faith. Help me to trust Your purposes even when I cannot understand them. Keep my eyes fixed on Jesus, who endured the cross and now reigns in glory. May I remain faithful until the day I stand before You.

In the name of Jesus Christ,
Amen.

Key Takeaway

Faithful disciples continue trusting God through every season, knowing that He is faithful to complete the work He has begun.

The True Light Principle

Perseverance is not trusting in our own strength—it is resting in God's faithfulness until the journey is complete.

Living for the Glory of God

Theme Verse

"So, whether you eat or drink, or whatever you do, do all to the glory of God."

(1 Corinthians 10:31)

Introduction

Why did God create us? Why did Christ redeem us? Why has the Holy Spirit transformed us? Why are we called to follow Jesus, bear fruit, love others, and make disciples?

The answer is found in one beautiful purpose: **To glorify God.** The highest purpose of every believer is not personal success. It is not recognition. It is not comfort. It is not even ministry itself. Our greatest purpose is to know God, enjoy Him, and glorify Him with every part of our lives. When God's glory becomes the center of our lives, every ordinary moment gains **eternal significance.**

I. What Does It Mean to Glorify God?

To glorify God means to **honor Him, reflect His character**, and acknowledge His greatness in everything we do. We cannot add to God's glory, for He is already infinitely glorious. But we can live in ways that reveal His goodness, wisdom, holiness, and love. Jesus perfectly glorified the Father through His obedience, humility, compassion, and sacrifice. As we become more like Christ, our lives also become a testimony to God's glory. Every act of faith, every word of truth, and every expression of love can **point others to Him**.

2. Every Part of Life Belongs to God

Paul reminds us,
"Whether you eat or drink, or whatever you do, do all to the glory of God."

Notice how comprehensive this is. God is not glorified only during worship services. He is glorified in our homes. In our work. In our conversations. In our decisions. In our relationships. In moments of joy. In seasons of hardship. **Every part of life becomes an opportunity to worship God through faithful living.** There is no divide between the "spiritual" and the "ordinary" life. For the disciple, all of life belongs to God.

3. A Life That Points to Christ

John the Baptist expressed the attitude of every faithful disciple
when he said,

"He must increase, but I must decrease."

(John 3:30)

The goal of the Christian life is not for people to remember our names. It is for them to remember **Jesus**. Our achievements... our gifts... our influence... our ministries... all find their true purpose when they direct people toward Christ. A life lived for God's glory is a life that consistently says, "**Look to Jesus.**"



4. Finishing the Journey Well

As we conclude this course, remember that discipleship is not a destination. *It is a lifelong journey. There will always be more to learn.* More opportunities to grow. More people to love. More ways to serve. More reasons to trust God. The purpose of this course has never been merely to increase knowledge. *It has been to encourage a lifelong walk with Jesus Christ.* **As you continue your journey, let every step bring glory to the One who called you out of darkness into His marvelous light.**



Reflection

Spend time quietly before the Lord and consider these questions:

- What is the deepest purpose of my life?
- In what areas do I still seek my own glory instead of God's?
- How can my daily work, relationships, and decisions honor Christ?
- What changes is God inviting me to make so that my life reflects His glory more clearly?

Write your reflections and dedicate every area of your life to Him.

Life Application

Begin each morning this week with one simple prayer: "Father, may everything I do today **bring glory to You.**"

Before making important decisions, ask yourself: "Will this choice honor Christ?"

Allow that question to guide your thoughts, your words, your relationships, and your actions. **Living for God's glory** is not about perfection. It is about **faithful surrender.**

Prayer

Heavenly Father,

Thank You for creating me in Your image and redeeming me through Your Son, Jesus Christ. Thank You for transforming my heart through the Holy Spirit and inviting me into Your Kingdom. May every part of my life bring honor to Your name. Teach me to **seek Your glory above my own**. *Help me to love as Christ loved, to serve as He served, and to faithfully follow Him all the days of my life. May others see Jesus in me and glorify You because of what You have done. Keep me faithful until the day I stand before You. In the precious name of Jesus Christ, Amen.*

Key Takeaway

The highest purpose of every disciple is to **glorify God by becoming more like Jesus Christ** in every area of life.

The True Light Principle

A life surrendered to Christ becomes a living reflection of God's glory, **bringing light, hope, and truth to the world**.

Course One Closing Encouragement

Congratulations. You have completed Course One: **From Self to Christ.**

This is not the end of your journey. It is the beginning of a new way of living. You have discovered that your **identity is found in Christ.** You have learned that God transforms the heart, renews the mind, and **leads us by His Spirit.**

You have entered the Kingdom of God, learned to **follow Jesus, abide in Him, bear the fruit of the Spirit, shine His light,** love others, make disciples, walk by faith, persevere through trials, and live for God's glory.

Now continue this journey with confidence. Walk humbly. Love generously. Serve faithfully. Trust completely. And let the **light of Jesus Christ** shine through your life every day. May the Lord bless you, strengthen you, and use you to bring **His light** to many people.